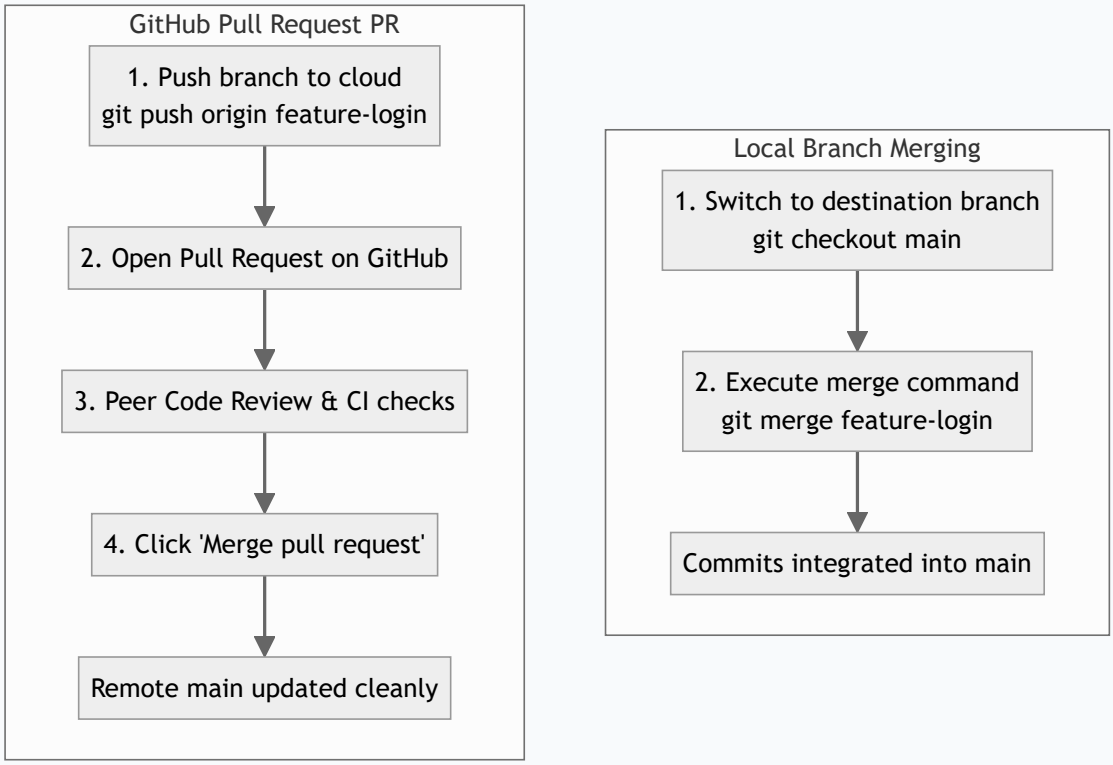
Submodule 35.16: Merging Branches & GitHub Pull Requests

1. What is Branch Merging?

Merging combines the independent commit history of one branch into another. Typically, once a feature or bugfix is completed and verified on a `feature` branch, it is merged into the primary `main` branch.



---

2. Local Branch Merge Workflow

Suppose you built a new file `app.js` inside `feature-button`:

1. **Switch to Target Branch**:

```
git checkout main
```

2. **Execute Merge**:

```
git merge feature-button
```

3. **Inspect History**:

```
git log --oneline
```

4. **Delete Obsolete Branch**:

```
git branch -d feature-button
```

---

3. The Professional GitHub Pull Request (PR) Workflow

In engineering teams, developers do not merge branches locally and push directly to `main`. Instead, they follow the **Pull Request** model:

1. **Push Feature Branch to Remote**:

```
git push origin feature-button
```

2. **Open Pull Request on GitHub**:
   - Go to your repository on GitHub.
   - Click the prominent yellow button: **Compare & pull request**.
3. **Describe Changes**:
   - Set base branch to `main` and compare branch to `feature-button`.
   - Add a descriptive title and bullet points outlining the implementation.
4. **Code Review & Automated Tests**:
   - Team members review line-by-line diffs, leave comments, and suggest improvements.
   - CI/CD pipelines run automated unit tests.
5. **Merge PR**:
   - Click **Merge pull request** *o* **Confirm merge**.
   - Click **Delete branch** on GitHub to keep remote tidy.
6. **Sync Local Machine**:

```
git checkout main
git pull origin main
```

---

4. Visual Reference

